02-14 第2篇

阅读理解（说明文） The Silk Road: An Old Path of Friendship

① More than 2,100 years ago, a tall man from Chang'an — today's Xi'an — set out with a few camels and thirty friends. His name was **Zhang Qian**, and he was sent by the Han emperor to find friends in the far west. Nobody at that time could guess that his journey would later open one of the longest and most famous roads in human history: **the Silk Road**.

② The Silk Road was not just one road. It was a network of dusty paths, stone bridges and desert routes, running more than **7,000 kilometres** from China all the way to the shores of the Mediterranean Sea. Camels became the ships of this "ocean of sand." A single trip could take more than a year, with travellers crossing freezing mountains, burning deserts and rushing rivers.

③ What travelled along this road? Silk, of course, gave the road its beautiful name. Soft, light and shining like water, Chinese silk was so loved in Rome that people once believed it grew on trees. But silk was only the beginning. **Paper**, **tea**, **porcelain** and **gunpowder** also moved westward, changing cooking, writing and even war in faraway lands. From the west, grapes, walnuts, carrots, music, dance and new faith travelled back to China.

④ Along the road stood many busy cities. Dunhuang, in today's Gansu Province, is a living example. Its **Mogao Caves**, carved into a tall cliff, hold thousands of colourful paintings and statues made over a thousand years. Travellers, traders and monks from many lands all stopped there, leaving their stories on the walls. Today, when we walk quietly inside a cave, we are walking through a long picture book of the ancient world.

⑤ However, the Silk Road was never only about goods. Ideas travelled too — slowly, like grain of sand, but never stopping. **Buddhism** entered China along this road. Chinese inventions, such as the compass and the art of making paper, later helped the West. On this long road, strangers became friends, shared a cup of tea under the stars, and discovered that though they spoke different languages, they shared the same hope — a peaceful life for their children.

⑥ Today, trains and planes have replaced most of the camels. Yet the spirit of the Silk Road is still alive. Modern projects bring trains from Chongqing to Duisburg and goods from Yiwu to Madrid. When we greet a friend from a distant country, perhaps we should remember the thirty men and their camels. A small journey of courage, two thousand years ago, is still teaching us the deepest lesson of all — that the world becomes wider and warmer whenever it opens its door.

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Who is called "the man who opened the Silk Road"?

A. A Roman merchant.
B. Zhang Qian from Chang'an.
C. An Indian monk.
D. A Persian king.

2. About how long was the Silk Road?

A. Less than 1,000 kilometres.
B. About 3,000 kilometres.
C. More than 7,000 kilometres.
D. More than 20,000 kilometres.

3. Which of the following was NOT sent from China to the West?

A. Silk.
B. Paper.
C. Porcelain.
D. Grapes.

4. What makes the Mogao Caves in Dunhuang so special?

A. They are the highest mountains on the Silk Road.
B. They hold thousands of paintings and statues from many travellers.
C. They are made entirely of silk.
D. They were closed to travellers in ancient times.

5. What is the writer's main point in the last paragraph?

A. Camels are more useful than trains today.
B. The Silk Road has been completely forgotten.
C. The spirit of the Silk Road still matters — the world opens its door and grows wider.
D. Only train drivers now know about Zhang Qian.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段 "His name was Zhang Qian"
【解析】张骞是开辟者。故选 B。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "more than 7,000 kilometres"
【解析】丝路逾 7000 公里。故选 C。

3.
【答案】D
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段 "grapes... travelled back to China"
【解析】葡萄由西方传入中国。故选 D。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段 "thousands of colourful paintings and statues"
【解析】莫高窟藏无数壁画与塑像。故选 B。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑥段 "the world becomes wider and warmer whenever it opens its door"
【解析】作者强调丝路精神仍在，开放使世界更宽广。故选 C。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **network** [n.] 网络
- **porcelain** [n.] 瓷器
- **compass** [n.] 指南针